



DASCATM

DATA SCIENCE COUNCIL OF AMERICA



CODE OF ETHICS & PROFESSIONAL CONDUCT

Code of Ethics & Professional Conduct

The Preamble

Data science is a transformative discipline with the power to shape decisions, influence policies, and drive innovation globally. With this potential comes the responsibility to uphold the highest standards of ethical conduct, ensuring that data science is practiced responsibly, equitably, and transparently.

The DASCA Code of Ethics establishes a clear framework to guide DASCA-certified professionals in navigating the ethical complexities of data science. By embracing this Code, certified professionals demonstrate their dedication to advancing trust, accountability, and the integrity of the data science profession.

Pledge of Commitment

As a DASCA-certified professional, I commit to upholding the principles outlined in this Code of Ethics. This commitment reflects my responsibility to act with integrity, maintain professional competence, and promote the ethical practice of data science.

By adhering to this Code, I affirm my role in fostering trust and excellence in the global data science community. I will:

- Uphold the principles of integrity, fairness, accountability, and transparency in all professional activities.
 - Protect the privacy, confidentiality, and rights of individuals and organizations.
 - Commit to ongoing professional development to ensure my skills and knowledge remain relevant in the rapidly evolving field of data science.
 - Avoid conflicts of interest and act in a manner that promotes trust and confidence in the data science profession.
 - Use my knowledge and expertise responsibly to contribute to societal benefits.
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Core Principles

Integrity

Act with honesty, transparency, and fairness in all professional activities. Avoid actions that could compromise trust in the profession.

Competence and Professional Growth

Commit to lifelong learning and the continuous development of professional knowledge and skills. Ensure competency in applying data science methodologies responsibly and ethically.

Confidentiality and Privacy

Safeguard sensitive information obtained during professional activities. Adhere to privacy laws and best practices to ensure data is handled securely and responsibly.

Fairness and Equity

Promote fairness by addressing biases in data, algorithms, and decision-making processes. Ensure equitable treatment of all stakeholders.

Accountability

Take responsibility for the consequences of data-driven decisions, ensuring transparency and fairness in methodologies and outcomes.

Social Responsibility

Consider the societal and environmental implications of your work. Use data science as a tool for positive impact, avoiding actions that could cause harm or exacerbate inequalities.

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Ethical Guidelines

1. Privacy and Data Protection

- Comply with relevant privacy regulations, including GDPR, HIPAA, and similar frameworks.
- Collect only the data necessary for your purposes, ensuring it is stored and shared securely.
- Implement measures such as anonymization and encryption to protect sensitive information.

3. Bias and Fairness

- Regularly evaluate datasets, models, and algorithms for biases that may result in unfair or discriminatory outcomes.
- Design solutions that promote inclusivity and equity across diverse populations.

5. Intellectual Property and Attribution

- Respect intellectual property rights and provide proper attribution for all resources, tools, and datasets used.
- Use data and tools only with proper authorization or licensing.

2. Avoiding Conflicts of Interest

- Disclose potential conflicts of interest promptly and transparently.
- Refrain from engaging in activities that may compromise professional objectivity or integrity.

4. Transparency and Communication

- Clearly articulate methodologies, assumptions, and limitations to stakeholders.
- Ensure data-driven decisions are communicated accurately and responsibly, avoiding misrepresentation.

6. Environmental and Societal Impact

- Strive to align your work with ethical and sustainable objectives, considering the long-term implications of your projects.
- Avoid practices that could cause harm to individuals, communities, or the environment.

Accountability and Enforcement

Professional Standards

DASCA-certified professionals are expected to adhere to this Code of Ethics as a condition of their certification.

Reporting Violations

DASCA encourages reporting of suspected unethical behavior through its confidential reporting channels. All concerns will be reviewed impartially and addressed in accordance with established procedures.

Disciplinary Actions

Violations of the DASCA Code of Ethics may result in sanctions, suspension, or revocation of certification. Disciplinary actions will be taken to uphold the integrity of the profession and protect public trust.

The DASCA Code of Ethics represents the collective commitment of DASCA-certified professionals to advance ethical practices in data science. Through adherence to these principles, we ensure that data science continues to be a force for innovation, equity, and societal good.